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Replaces:
N/A

WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

Productivity Suite
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Productivity Suite, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. The Productivity Suite provides a centrally governed, enterprise-level capability for communication, collaboration, and productivity across Washington state government. It enables consistent, secure, and efficient interaction among agencies, employees, partners, and external parties.

The Productivity Suite is designated as an enterprise service to reduce duplication, improve interoperability, strengthen security, and enable statewide collaboration at scale.

A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

In Scope

The Productivity Suite must be used for the communication, collaboration, and productivity capabilities listed in Section 4.

Out of Scope

The following capabilities are not in scope of this standard:

1. Specialized applications that include embedded collaboration features not intended for general productivity use (e.g., law enforcement records management, electronic health records management).
2. Public-facing communication and document sharing platforms used exclusively for engagement with external users (e.g., Box, broadcast-only systems, reservation systems).
3. The use of Zoom when necessary for collaboration with external organizations or individuals, or when required to accommodate accessibility needs. Such use may

supplement Microsoft Teams, but shall not serve as a replacement for Teams as the primary video platform.

4. One-time or ad hoc communication methods that do not establish an ongoing capability.
5. Systems used exclusively for emergency response communications when governed by separate statutory or operational requirements.
6. Systems or environments that are legally, federally, or contractually required to operate in a segregated or restricted technology environment where use of the enterprise service is not permitted (e.g., federally classified or controlled federal environments).
7. Capabilities that are embedded within a specialized system and cannot be reasonably separated without introducing significant operational risk (e.g., public safety dispatch, emergency response, corrections management system, RightFax as part of the DES Managed Print Service).
8. Capabilities related to digital visualization, automation, and development.

3. APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020) and their organizational users (including employees, contractors, partners, and vendors).

This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, legislature, judiciary, or local governments.

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Productivity Suite enterprise service designation encompasses the capabilities listed below. Note that the vendors and products listed represent current examples and are subject to change.

1. Email and calendar-based communication (Microsoft Exchange).
2. Real-time communication using chat, voice, video, or virtual meetings (Microsoft Teams).
3. Document storage and collaboration (Microsoft OneDrive).
4. Team-based or cross-agency collaboration (Microsoft SharePoint).
5. Digital workplace tools for word-processing, spreadsheets, and presentations as the primary toolset for an agency (Microsoft Office Word, Excel, and PowerPoint).
6. Electronic faxing functionality, allowing users to send and receive faxes via email, computer, tablet, or smartphone (eFax).

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria.

The following exemptions apply to electronic faxing capabilities:

1. High volume fax servers
2. Fax servers that have document management systems

6. AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants WaTech authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services. RCW 43.105.385 establishes WaTech as the central service provider for state agencies, supporting the delivery of common enterprise technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Productivity Suite
2. Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports
3. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
4. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
5. RCW 43.105.385 Agency as central service provider for state agencies
6. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.